

No — **now** has more than one useful modern meaning, although it has **one strong central time meaning** and several important extensions. I would **not** split every expression into a completely separate dictionary sense.

Word family: **now / nowadays**

Base word: now

Main part of speech: adverb (副詞)

Also: noun in limited uses

Useful expressions: right now, just now, by now, for now, from now on, now that, now and then

Related word: nowadays

Your sentence:

> “I still use them **now**, especially when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **now** means:

at the present time, as opposed to the earlier time when the speaker first bought the headphones.

繁體中文: **現在; 目前; 在說話者所處的現階段**

Natural translation:

> “I still use them now...”

「我**現在仍然**會使用它們.....」

Here:

now = 現在這個時候 / 目前

1. **now = at the present time (現在 / 目前) — 現在; 目前**

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I still use them **now**.”

「我**現在仍然**會使用它們。」

Practice 2

> “I work from home ****now****.”

「我****現在****在家工作。」

Practice 3

> “The café is much busier ****now****.”

「那間咖啡店****現在****忙碌得多。」

****now** = 在說話或寫作所指的現階段, 而不是過去或未來******

2. ****now** = immediately / without delay (立即) — 現在就; 立刻******

This is closely related to “present time,” but the emphasis changes from ****when something is true**** to ****when something must happen****.

Practice 4

> “We need to leave ****now****.”

「我們****現在就要走／必須立刻離開****。」

Practice 5

> “Do it ****now****, not later.”

「****現在就做****, 不要等到之後。」

****now** = 不要延遲, 立即在這一刻採取行動******

Compare:

> “I live here now.”

> = 我目前住在這裡。

> “Come here now.”

> = 你現在立刻過來。

3. **now** = at this point in a changing situation (到了現在／此刻已經) — 現在; 如今

Often used when something has changed from an earlier state.

Practice 6

> “I didn’t understand it before, but **now** I do.”

「我以前不明白, 但**現在**明白了。」

Practice 7

> “The technology was once expensive, but it is affordable **now**.”

「這種科技以前很昂貴, 但**如今**已經負擔得起。」

now = 經歷了一段時間或情況改變後, 到目前這個階段

This is still part of the central “present time” sense, but the **past-versus-present contrast** is especially strong.

4. **now** = discourse marker (轉換話題／引起注意) — 那麼; 好了; 現在

This is genuinely different in function.

Now can introduce:

- * a new topic,
- * an explanation,
- * an instruction,
- * the next stage of something.

Practice 8

> “**Now**, let’s look at the second example.”

「**好了**／**現在**, 我們來看看第二個例子。」

Practice 9

> “**Now**, there is one important point to remember.”

「**那麼／現在**，有一點很重要的事情需要記住。」

Here, **now** does not literally mean “at the present moment.” It helps organize the conversation.

now — discourse marker = 用來引出下一個話題、步驟或重點

5. **now that + clause (情況已改變) — 既然現在……; 由於現在……**

This is a very important fixed construction.

Practice 10

> “**Now that** I have the headphones, travelling is much easier.”

「**既然我現在有了這副耳機**，旅行就輕鬆得多。」

Practice 11

> “**Now that** the work is finished, we can relax.”

「**既然工作已經完成了**，我們可以放鬆一下。」

now that = 某個新情況現在已經成立，因此可以作出後面的結論或行動

It often translates naturally as:

既然……／由於現在……

not literally 「現在那個」.

6. **for now = temporarily / until circumstances change — 暫時; 目前先**

Practice 12

> “This solution is good enough **for now**.”

「這個解決方法**暫時來說**已經足夠。」

Practice 13

> “I’ll keep the old laptop ****for now****.”

「我****目前暫時****會繼續使用舊手提電腦。」

****for now** = 在目前這段時間先這樣, 但將來可能改變******

Important distinction:

> ****now**** = 現在

> ****for now**** = 暫時／目前先

7. ****by now** = before or no later than the present time — 到現在應該已經; 截至目前******

Practice 14

> “She should be home ****by now****.”

「她****現在應該已經****到家了。」

Practice 15

> “You probably know the answer ****by now****.”

「****到了現在****, 你大概已經知道答案了。」

****by now** = 從較早時間一直計算到現在這個時間點, 某事預期已經發生******

8. ****from now on** = starting now and continuing into the future — 從現在開始; 今後******

Practice 16

> “I’ll be more careful ****from now on****.”

「我****從現在開始／今後****會更加小心。」

Practice 17

> “From now on, all reports must be submitted online.”

「**從現在開始**，所有報告都必須在網上提交。」

from now on = 以現在為起點，之後持續採取某種做法

9. **right now = exactly now / immediately — 此刻；馬上**

Practice 18

> “I’m busy **right now**.”

「我**此刻／現在正**很忙。」

Practice 19

> “I need an answer **right now**.”

「我**現在馬上**需要答案。」

right now can emphasize either:

* exactly at this moment → **此刻**

* immediately → **馬上**

10. **just now = a very short time ago / at this moment — 剛才；此刻**

This one needs care because usage can vary.

Practice 20

> “I saw her **just now**.”

「我**剛才**見到她。」

Practice 21

> “I can’t talk **just now**.”

「我**現在這一刻**不方便說話。」

In many contexts, especially British English:

****just now = 剛才****

but it can also mean:

****就在此刻／目前****

Context determines the meaning.

11. ****now and then = occasionally — 偶爾; 有時候****

A common fixed expression.

Practice 22

> “I still visit that café ****now and then****.”

「我仍然會****偶爾****去那間咖啡店。」

Practice 23

> “Everyone needs a break ****now and then****.”

「每個人都需要****偶爾****休息一下。」

****now and then = 並非經常, 只是偶爾發生****

Equivalent to:

****from time to time****

12. ****the now = the present moment (較抽象／較少見) — 當下; 此刻****

Here, ****now**** functions as a noun.

Practice 24

> “Try to live in the ****now****.”

「嘗試活在****當下****。」

Practice 25

> “She tries to focus on the **here and now**.”

「她嘗試專注於**當下眼前的生活**。」

the now = 當前這一刻, 被視為一個概念

The much more common expression is:

> **the here and now**

= **此時此刻／當下現實**

Related word: **nowadays** — 如今; 現今

Nowadays refers broadly to **the present period of history or modern life**, rather than this exact moment.

Practice 26

> “People use wireless headphones everywhere **nowadays**.”

「**現今／如今**人們到處都會使用無線耳機。」

Practice 27

> “It is much easier to work remotely **nowadays**.”

「**現今**遙距工作容易得多。」

nowadays = 在現今這個時代／現代社會中

Important distinction: **now** vs **nowadays**

now

= this present moment or current situation

> “I’m busy now.”

「我現在很忙。」

nowadays

= modern times generally

> “People are busier nowadays.”

「現今人們普遍更忙。」

So:

> “I use these headphones now.”

> = 我現在有在用這副耳機。

> “Headphones are common nowadays.”

> = 現今耳機很普遍。

Important distinction: **now vs currently**

now

natural in everyday speech.

currently

more formal and emphasizes the present situation.

> “I’m working from home now.”

Everyday.

> “The system is currently unavailable.”

「系統目前無法使用。」

Important distinction: **now vs immediately**

now

can mean either “at present” or “immediately.”

immediately

specifically emphasizes **without delay**.

> “I work here now.”

= 我現在在這裡工作。

Not “immediately.”

> “Come here now!”

= 馬上過來！

Here it overlaps with **immediately**.

Family sweep

Now actually has a small lexical family. The useful learning material comes mostly from its fixed constructions:

* **now** = 現在／目前

* **now!** = 現在就／立刻

* **now — discourse marker** = 那麼／好了

* **now that** = 既然現在……

* **right now** = 此刻／馬上

* **just now** = 剛才；此刻

* **for now** = 暫時／目前先

* **by now** = 到現在應該已經

* **from now on** = 從現在開始

* **now and then** = 偶爾

* **the here and now** = 此時此刻／當下

* **nowadays** = 如今／現今

I would **not invent extra derivational forms** because there really aren't many useful ones.

Master comparison

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now — present time	在說話或寫作所指的目前這個時間／階段	
now — immediately	不作延遲, 在這一刻立即採取行動	
now — changed situation	經過先前狀態或情況改變後, 到目前已經呈現的新狀況	
now — discourse marker	用來引出下一個話題、步驟、說明或重點	
now that	某個新情況現在已經成立, 因此作出後面的結論／行動	
for now	目前暫時維持某狀態, 但將來可能改變	
by now	截至目前這個時間點, 某事預期已經發生	
from now on	以現在為起點, 之後持續如此	
right now	正在此刻; 或需要立即、不延遲	
just now	剛才不久; 某些語境亦可指此刻	
now and then	並非經常, 只是偶爾發生	
the here and now	現實中正在發生的此時此刻／當下	
nowadays	現今這個時代或現代社會中	

For your original sentence

> “I still use them ****now****, especially when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

Here ****now**** is the straightforward central meaning:

****now = 在說話者目前所處的時間／現階段****

So:

> ****I still use them now****

= ****「我現在仍然會使用它們。」****

And yes — ****now definitely has more than one useful use****, but many of them grow naturally from the central concept of ****the present time****, so we should not artificially treat every expression as an unrelated lexical meaning.